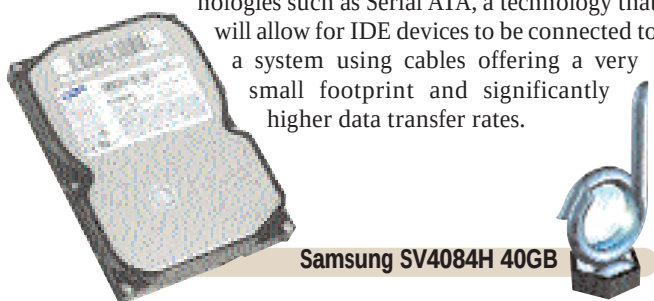


HARD DISKS (IDE – 5,400 RPM)

In the entry-level segment, there has been a spurt in the performance of drives with the advent of newer technologies such as ATA/133 and greater areal densities. While sheer performance is not really the criteria here, what's more important is the value proposition that these drives bring in case you want to assemble a computer system. These drives hit a sweet spot in price and pure storage space, offering a whopping 100 GB space!

A clear trend in this category is the ever-increasing capacities of these drives. With the areal densities of these drives becoming greater, more data can be packed onto a single platter and the coming year is expected to witness the arrival of IDE drives with capacities in excess of 150 GB. Also on the horizon are technologies such as Serial ATA, a technology that will allow for IDE devices to be connected to a system using cables offering a very small footprint and significantly higher data transfer rates.



Samsung SV4084H 40GB

A blazingly fast drive with ample capacity that is light on the wallet

When it comes to an affordable drive that delivers good performance for entry-level applications, the 40 GB Samsung drive wins top honours. It boasted very good data transfer characteristics and also proved to be a silent performer. It logged a sequential write speed of 29 MBps, which is better than even some of the 7200-rpm drives. The average access time under SiSoft Sandra 2001te was noted at an unbelievably low 2 ms and it utilised very little CPU power.

+ Good data transfer speed
+ Affordable pricing
Price: Rs 6,000
Contact: Samsung Electronics India
Phone: 011-6322517/18/19

Fax: 011-6322607
E-mail: marketing@samsungindia.com
Reviewed in: November 2001

Worthy Mentions

Maxtor 536DX 100GB

+ The largest capacity available in the country
+ Very commendable read-write speeds
Price: Rs 12,800
Contact: eSys Distribution
Phone: 011-6420451/450/453
Fax: 011-6420452
E-mail: anshuman@karmasg.com
Reviewed in: November 2001

Maxtor D540X 80GB

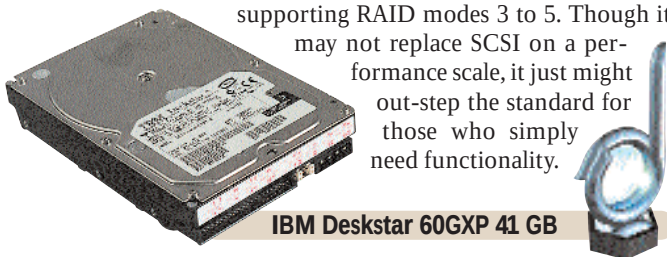
+ Good data transfer characteristics
+ High storage capacity
Price: Rs 4,490
Contact: eSys Distribution
Phone: 011-6420451/450/453
Fax: 011-6420452
E-mail: anshuman@karmasg.com
Reviewed in: November 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: NA 1999: Quantum Fireball CR
1998: Maxtor Diamond 1260 Model 88400DS

HARD DISKS (IDE – 7,200 RPM)

Just because IDE drives are positioned as affordable, they are not necessarily as slow as a lumbering hippo. In the course of this year alone, storage densities have increased by 400 per cent! That means more data zips through for transfer per rotation. Faster-spinning 7,200-rpm drives push more data through per second than older and slower 5,400-rpm discs which are slowly giving way to these faster drives on desktop PCs.

In the coming year IDE technology is about to get a booster shot. Drives based on the ATA133 protocol are about to make their entry into the market. ATA133 allows for 33 per cent greater bandwidth than the current ATA100 standard. Serial ATA is the next major revision for IDE peripherals which should make its presence felt in 2002. With initial speeds of 1.5 Gigabits per second (Gbps), Serial ATA will scale to a higher speed of 6 Gbps by 2007. IDE RAID is taking a major step forward by supporting RAID modes 3 to 5. Though it may not replace SCSI on a performance scale, it just might out-step the standard for those who simply need functionality.



IBM Deskstar 60GXP 41 GB

Best suited for applications that demand more from your computer's storage sub-system and for sustained performance of media-intensive software

This is one of the most outstanding drives when it comes to performance. Be it data transfer rates or access times, this hard disk delivers while working with gobs of data, as was amply demonstrated in our benchmarks. With a 7,200 rpm spindle speed and an ample 2 MB buffer onboard, this drive is best suited for applications such as databases and audio video editing that demand more from your computer's storage subsystem.

+ Excellent data transfer rate
+ Very silent
Price: Rs 7,300
Contact: Wales Technologies
Phone: 022-3828100 / 8200
Fax: 022-3877418
Reviewed in: November 2001

Worthy Mentions

Seagate Barracuda ST32041A

+ Very good performance at an affordable price
+ Silent operation
Price: Rs 4,750
Contact: ACI Infocom Ltd
Phone: 022-8266031 / 32
Fax: 022-8250674
E-mail: abhishek@aciinfo.com
Reviewed in: November 2001

IBM Deskstar 75GXP 76.8GB

+ Very silent operation
+ Best-of-class read/write speeds
Price: Not available
Contact: Wales Technologies
Phone: 022-3828100 / 8200
Fax: 022-3877418
Reviewed in: November 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: IBM DeskStar 72GXP DTLA-307075
1999: NA 1998: NA